

Purpose: To help us understand the joy that comes when we repent and when we help others repent.

1. The Savior teaches the worth of souls.

- Read and discuss [Luke 15:1-10](#). “Jesus presented the parable of the lost sheep and the parable of the piece of silver after the Pharisees and scribes murmured, ‘This man receiveth sinners, and eateth with them’ (Luke 15:2).” (*LM*)
- Luke 15:4-7. Which of you “having an hundred sheep, if he lose one of them, doth not ... go after that which is lost”?
- Luke 15:8-10. What “woman having ten pieces of silver, if she lose one piece, doth not ... seek diligently”?
- D&C 18:10-13. The “worth of souls is great in the sight of God ... how great is his joy in the soul that repenteth!”

In what ways might a person be “lost”?

What is our responsibility toward those who are lost? (See Luke 15:4-5, 8 and [Alma 31:34-35](#).)

†1. President Gordon B. Hinckley

How should we respond at the return of a person who has been lost? (See [D&C 18:15-16](#).)

2. Jesus teaches that Heavenly Father rejoices in forgiving the repentant.

- Read and discuss [Luke 15:11-32](#).

- Luke 15:13. He “took his journey into a far country, and there wasted his substance with riotous living.”

“Note that *prodigal* means wasteful.” (*Lesson Manual*) †2. President Gordon B. Hinckley

What are some ways that people today make errors similar to those of the prodigal son?

- Luke 15:14-16. “And when he had spent all, there arose a mighty famine in the land; and he began to be in want.”

What can we learn from the phrase “and no man gave unto him”?

- Luke 15:17-19. “And when he came to himself, he said ...”

What can we learn about repentance from this son’s attitude?

- Luke 15:20-24. “But ... a great way off, his father saw him, ... and ran, and fell on his neck, and kissed him.”

How might the father’s response be like our Heavenly Father’s response?

(See [Luke 15:7](#); [Mosiah 26:30](#); [D&C 58:42](#).)

In what ways are we like the prodigal son? †3. President Gordon B. Hinckley †4. Elder Neal A. Maxwell

- Luke 15:25-30. “Lo, these many years do I serve thee ... and yet thou never gavest me a kid”.

- Luke 15:31-32. “Son, ... all that I have is thine... be glad: for this thy brother was dead, and is alive again”.

What can we learn from this father’s response?

3. A man whom Jesus has healed of leprosy returns to thank him.

- Read and discuss [Luke 17:11-19](#). †5. Stephen Glenn and Jane Nelson

What are some reasons that we, like the nine ungrateful lepers, do not always express our gratitude for the blessings we receive?

Why is it important that we express gratitude to the Lord?

- Luke 17:14, 19. The ten “were cleansed... And he said unto him ... thy faith hath made thee whole.”

What is the difference between being healed and being made whole? †6. Bishop Merrill J. Bateman

†7. Elder David B. Haight †8. Elder Dallin H. Oaks

President Brigham Young: “I do not know of any, excepting the unpardonable sin, that is greater than the sin of ingratitude.” (*Discourses of Brigham Young*, 228)

Next Week: L19 “Thy Faith Hath Saved Thee”; See L17: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

†1. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** "... There are those who were once warm in the faith, but whose faith has grown cold. Many of them wish to come back but do not know quite how to do it. They need friendly hands reaching out to them. With a little effort, many of them can be brought back to feast again at the table of the Lord.

"My brethren and sisters, I would hope, I would pray that each of us ... would resolve to seek those who need help, who are in desperate and difficult circumstances, and lift them in the spirit of love into the embrace of the Church, where strong hands and loving hearts will warm them, comfort them, sustain them, and put them on the way of happy and productive lives" ("[Reach with a Rescuing Hand](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 1996, 86).

†2. **Elder Brent H. Nielson:** "The prodigal son informs his father that he wants his inheritance now. He wants to leave the safety of his home and family and seek after worldly pursuits (see Luke 15:12-13)..."

"My family had a similar experience. My two faithful brothers, wonderful sister, and I were raised by exemplary parents..." ("[Waiting for the Prodigal](#)," *Ensign*, May 2015, 101).

†3. **President Gordon B. Hinckley:** "I ask you to read that story. Every parent ought to read it again and again. It is large enough to encompass every household, and enough larger than that to encompass all mankind, for are we not all prodigal sons and daughters who need to repent and partake of the forgiving mercy of our Heavenly Father and then follow His example?" ("[Of You It Is Required to Forgive](#)," *Ensign*, June 1991, 5).

†4. **Elder Neal A. Maxwell:** "There are many prodigals who lack the meekness and the intellectual clarity to do what the prodigal son did. Saying, in effect, 'Living like this is ridiculous!', the prodigal son 'came to himself.' He realized how much better off he would be to return to his father... Being sufficiently meek to feel caused him to think, and humbleness of mind saved his soul." (*Meek and Lowly*, 48)

†5. **Stephen Glenn and Jane Nelson:**

- "1. Do you have more than one pair of shoes?
- "2. Do you have more than one choice about what you will eat for each meal?
- "3. Do you have access to your own means of transportation?
- "4. Do you have more than one set of underwear? ...

"Fewer than 10 percent of all the people who have ever lived have been able to answer 'yes' to three or more of these questions at any one time in their lives." (*Raising Self-Reliant Children in a Self-Indulgent World*, 44-45; cited in [Prayers That Bring Miracles](#), 36-37)

†6. **Bishop Merrill J. Bateman:** "In becoming a whole person, the grateful leper was healed inside as well as on the outside. That day nine lepers were healed skin deep, but only one had the faith to be made whole.

"The Savior's atonement in the garden and on the cross is intimate as well as infinite. Infinite in that it spans the eternities. Intimate in that the Savior felt each person's pains, sufferings, and sicknesses. Consequently, he knows how to carry our sorrow and relieve our burdens that we might be healed from within, made whole persons, and receive everlasting joy in his kingdom. May our faith in the Father and the Son help each of us to become whole" ("[The Power to Heal From Within](#)," *Ensign*, May 1995, 14).

†7. **Elder David B. Haight:** "As I've read that story again and again, it's made a great impression upon me. How would you like to be part of the 'nine society'? Wouldn't that be something—to be numbered among those who failed to return and acknowledge the Savior for the blessings he had given them? Only one returned.

"... I would remind all of you that if we're ever going to show gratitude properly to our Heavenly Father, we should do it with all of our heart, might, mind, and strength—because it was He who gave us life and breath... As that gratitude is magnified and developed and expanded, it can bless our hearts and our minds and our souls to where we'd like to continue to carry on and do those things that we are asked to do." ("[Were There Not Ten Cleansed?](#)" *Ensign*, Nov. 2002)

†8. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** "In one of the times of spiritual and temporal adversity recorded in the Book of Mormon, when the people of God were 'suffering all manner of afflictions,' the Lord commanded them to 'give thanks in all things' ([Mosiah 26:38-39](#)) ...

"We give thanks for commandments. They are directions away from pitfalls, and they are invitations to blessings. Commandments mark the path and show us the way to happiness in this life and eternal life in the world to come..." ("[Give Thanks in All Things](#)," *Ensign*, May 2003)

Recommended Reading:

1. Elder Brent H. Nielson, "[Waiting for the Prodigal](#)," *Ensign*, May 2015.
1. President Gordon B. Hinckley, "[Reach with a Rescuing Hand](#)," *Ensign*, Nov. 1996.

Recommended Videos:

1. [The Prodigal Son](#) (5:35).
2. [Prodigal Son—Elder Robert D. Hales](#) (1:56).
3. [New Testament Customs—Leprosy](#) (1:01).
4. [Taking the Lord's Blessings for Granted](#) (3:36).

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